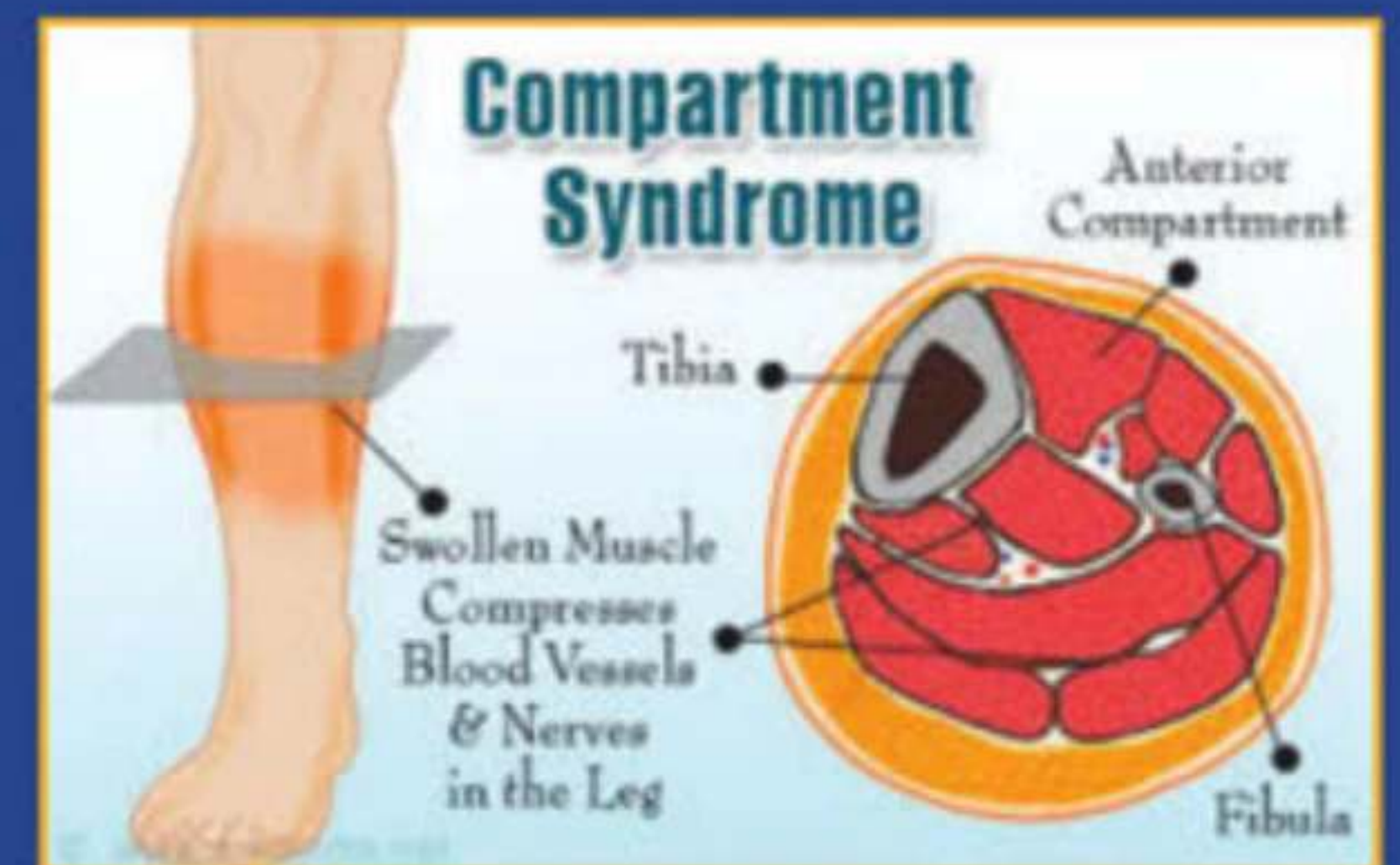


COMPARTMENT SYNDROME



Compartment Syndrome (CS), also known as **Chronic Exertional Compartment Syndrome (CECS)**, is a painful condition arising from increased pressure within a muscle compartment. What are compartments? Imagine your muscles neatly packaged within sturdy, non-stretch sleeves called **FASCIA** – these are compartments. They contain muscles, nerves, and blood vessels, all encased by the fascia. Now this aforementioned elevated pressure in the compartment restricts blood flow, compresses nerves and causes significant discomfort. While it can occur in various parts of the body, the lower legs are most commonly affected.

THE MECHANISM OF PAIN

During intense exercise, muscles swell. Within the confined space of the compartment, this swelling increases pressure. The inelastic fascia acts like a rigid wall, trapping the excess fluid and further compresses the delicate structures within. This restricted blood flow deprives muscles and nerves of vital oxygen and nutrients, leading to pain, numbness, and potential tissue damage.

Overuse from repetitive high impact activity, Increased muscle bulk, tight fascia can all contribute to the increased pressure and thereby predispose us to CECS.

Symptoms of compartment syndrome include pain, tightness, cramping, burning sensation, numbness, tingling, and swelling in the affected limb.

Treatment typically begins with conservative measures such as rest, modifying activity level, and engaging in regular physical therapy. However, if these approaches fail to alleviate symptoms, surgical intervention may be necessary to relieve the pressure within the compartment.

Halt Sports Injuries (HSI) : An Ortho One Initiative to create awareness through learning sessions and provide medical support at subsidised cost for deserving sports persons.

(Note: Donations are exempt under 80(G) and CSR Income Tax act)

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